17
Kargil
The Pakistani Misadventure

Jehad cannot be conducted with lies.
– *Jasarat*, the mouthpiece of Jamaat-e-Islami Pakistan.[1]

The Pakistan Army's misadventure in Kargil resulted in the Kargil war during May-June-July in 1999. In my tenure as the ADGMO in the military operations directorate at the Army HQ, this war was the most important challenge the nation faced. The initial surprise gained by the enemy was countered by a fierce response by the Indian Army. India's commendable achievement of giving the adversary a bloody nose, and throwing most of the Pakistani intruders [principally comprising battalions of the Northern Light Infantry (NLI) and elements of the regular Pakistan Army such as the Special Service Group (SSG)] back across the LoC, has been remarkable. A large number of their soldiers perished due to the harsh conditions in this rash and miscalculated venture. Eventually, an unambiguous victory was achieved by the Indian armed forces, as the Pakistani leadership agreed to withdraw the remnants of their force to their side of the LoC. So much has been written about this quaint and queer localized war, in a region that comprises barren glacial and high-altitude wastes of the tallest mountain ranges in the world.

The response of the Indian nation, and principally its army and the air force, despite the initial confusion and shock, was a fine example of the resolute will of the people and our armed forces, who were determined to avenge Pakistani aggression, and achieve victory at all costs. This was indeed beyond the comprehension of